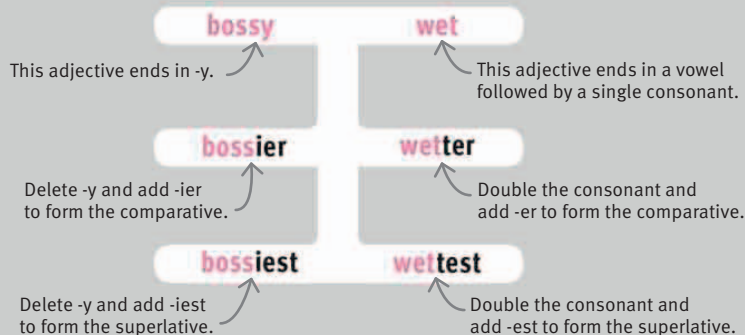




Identifying irregular adjective spellings

Some adjectives do not follow the rules when it comes to forming their comparatives or superlatives. If an adjective already ends in -e (*rude*), only -r needs to be added to make it comparative (*ruder*), and -st, to make it superlative (*rudest*). Words ending in -y or a vowel and a single consonant have to change their endings.



Exceptions

Some two-syllable adjectives, such as *lovely*, can take either form of the comparative or superlative (see “Awkward adjectives”). Other adjectives change completely when they are used to compare things. These comparative and superlative forms have to be learned.

Adjective	Comparative	Superlative
good	better	best
bad	worse	worst
much	more	most
many	more	most
little	less	least
quiet	quieter or more quiet	quietest or most quiet
simple	simpler or more simple	simplest or most simple
clever	cleverer or more clever	cleverest or most clever
lovely	lovelier or more lovely	loveliest or most lovely

carousel, but the roller coaster is train is the **most frightening**.

Awkward adjectives

If adding the ending -er or -est results in an odd-sounding adjective, the comparative and superlative are formed using the words *more* or *most* before the adjective. This applies to most two-syllable adjectives and all adjectives with three or more syllables.

The ghost train is the **most** frightening.

The superlative *frighteningest* is hard to say, so—because *frightening* has three syllables—the superlative is formed using *most*.

